Welcome to automakers' earnings week

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【要点】

・欧州の自動車メーカーが今週決算説明会を開催し、排出ガス基準の妥協案やEU政策の影響について投資家に説明する機会となる。

・Volvoが業績不振を理由に5億ユーロのコスト削減計画を発表し、世界規模で2,500人の雇用削除を計画しており、米国の関税と中国市場の販売低迷が影響している。

・欧州の自動車メーカーは米国の関税圧力と中国市場の過飽和・経済停滞により経営環境が悪化しており、複数のメーカーが同様の課題を抱えている。

・Volvoは7つの工場のうち2つが過剰と判断し、ベルギーとカンダの工場をGeely傘下の企業に開放する構造改革を進めている。

・Lufthansaはグリーンウォッシング疑惑を解決するため、「Green Fare」の名称をEU規制に準拠するよう変更した。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By JORDYN DAHL with TOMMASO LECCA SNEAK PEEK — Europe's automakers will have th

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure.

By JORDYN DAHL

with TOMMASO LECCA

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SNEAK PEEK

— Europe's automakers will have their chance to react to recent compromises in Brussels on emission standards and the IAA when they go before investors this week.

— Lufthansa changed the name of its Green Fare to comply with new EU rules, ending a long feud with the Commission and consumer associations over accusations of greenwashing.

— The Irish Council presidency shared details on its roadmap for adopting a general approach to the ETS revision in December.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

EUROPE'S AUTOMAKERS TALK FINANCES, POLICY: It's earnings week for most of Europe's automakers, and the first opportunity for executives to comment on the French-German deal (more on that below) and the compromise in the European Parliament on emission targets for automakers. For Volkswagen, it's the first call with investors since it came to a deal on a massive cost-cutting plan with the workers' union. Here's everything you need to know.

Timetable: Mercedes-Benz , Stellantis and Renault have their earnings calls on Wednesday, followed by Volkswagen on Thursday. BMW's call is early next month.

Not a good start: The earnings season started on a low note on Friday with Swedish brand Volvo. The automaker, which was bought by Chinese state company Geely in 2010, announced plans to cut 5 billion Swedish krona (€449 million) in costs, including eliminating an additional 2,500 jobs worldwide, with 2,000 of the roles based in Sweden. "The conclusion is the business environment has turned worse than we anticipated," CEO Håkan Samuelsson told investors.

Volvo's woes are likely to be echoed by its European counterparts, thanks to the double whammy of U.S. tariffs and declining sales in China.

Trade troubles: European automakers have been hit hard by tariffs from the U.S. — Volvo exports the bulk of its vehicles there. It will start producing its XC60 SUV in the United States early next year to get around the tariffs.

All eyes on China: Overall sales for European automakers are down in China due to oversaturation in the market, a sluggish economy and shifting consumer preferences toward tech-heavy domestic brands. Volvo saw its sales drop 50% year-over-year in the third quarter of this year. Volkswagen is even more exposed to China, which was once its biggest market.

Factory restructuring: Volvo has seven global plants, which Samuelsson said is two too many. It is opening its factory in Gent, Belgium and Chengdu, China to parent company Geely and other brands that need capacity.

Forget the global car: For decades, automakers have built one model that could sell in most markets with some tweaks for local tastes or regulations. Not anymore. "We need to have regional products. Global products will not work in China anymore, and we need to localize more products to U.S., and we need absolutely a complete all-electric product offering for Europe," Samuelsson said. "One-size-fits-all will not work in the future."

By the numbers: Ahead of its earnings call, Volkswagen announced its global sales declined 9% in the first nine months of the year, from 6.6 million in 2025 to 6.01 million this year, brought down by a 30% year-over-year drop in China sales.

AVIATION

LUFTHANSA RENAMES GREEN FARE TO COMPLY WITH EU RULES: Lufthansa announced Friday that it was renaming its Green Fare to Impact Fare, noting that the change "reflects new regulatory requirements for environmental communication." The airline group told Tommaso that the name change is intended to comply with requirements under the EU EmpCo Directive , which governs environmental and sustainability claims in communications with customers.

Green promise: Through two fare options, Economy Green and Business Green, Lufthansa had promised customers it would "reduce 20% of flight-related CO2 emissions by the use of sustainable aviation fuels

(SAF) and offset the remaining 80% of the CO2 emissions by an equivalent contribution to high-quality climate protection projects." The European Consumer Organisation, or BEUC, filed a greenwashing complaint with the Commission in 2023 against 17 carriers and airline groups such as Lufthansa, Air France-KLM, IAG and Ryanair.

Flying is not "green": The Commission launched an action against 20 airlines in 2024 over "potentially misleading green claims and inviting them to bring their practices in line with EU consumer law within 30 days." Last year, the Commission announced commitments by 21 airlines, including Lufthansa, to stop claiming that the emissions of a specific flight "could be neutralised, offset, or directly reduced by consumer financial contributions to climate protection projects" or through the use of sustainable aviation fuel.

Making it official: A new directive came into force at the end of September that introduced binding restrictions on such environmental claims. The new rules restrict the use of vague environmental claims in marketing, such as "green," "environmentally friendly," "eco-friendly" and "nature's friend," unless the company can demonstrate the excellent environmental performance implied by those claims.

What's changing? Under Lufthansa's new Impact Fare, the airline will continue to allocate SAF and support climate protection projects in connection with customer bookings. For every booking, Lufthansa said Friday that it "deploys an additional amount of SAF in its flight operations within six months of departure."

The details: For flights within Europe, "this volume is based on 20 percent of the estimated flight-related CO2 emissions." A customer purchasing an Impact Fare "also supports climate protection projects" through a contribution calculated on the basis of the remaining 80 percent of the flight's estimated CO2 emissions. For intercontinental flights, the proportions are 10 percent for SAF and 90 percent for climate protection projects.

Time to digest: BEUC did not immediately respond to a request for comment on whether the new fare addresses its previous greenwashing concerns.

EMISSIONS

IRISH PRESIDENCY DETAILS ROADMAP FOR ETS GENERAL APPROACH: The Irish Council presidency told diplomats Friday that its first compromise draft on the revision of the Emissions Trading System will be presented this week, followed by bilateral talks with EU countries in early November, a presidency spokesperson said after the meeting.

A diplomat from another country told Tommaso that proposals concerning aviation and maritime transport were not discussed at the meeting.

First, the technical: The upcoming first draft is expected to include only technical revisions to the Commission's proposal. During the discussion, some countries called for the European Council's conclusions on ETS2 , which will cover emissions from fuel combustion in buildings and road transport, to be reflected in the revision.

A reminder: At the latest summit, leaders called on the Commission "to update the assessment of all impacts of ETS2, in particular its design and safeguards."

Then, the political: A second compromise text will be issued in mid-November, the Irish spokesperson said, confirming its ambition to reach a general approach at the Dec. 11 meeting of environment

ministers.

CARS

FRANCO-GERMAN DEAL LEAVES MUCH TO BE DESIRED: Not everyone is happy with the recent French-German deal that saw Berlin give way on which countries would qualify as “Made in Europe” under the Industrial Accelerator Act in exchange for weakening emission targets for automakers. The automotive industry says it doesn’t go far enough, while experts say it won’t make the sector more competitive against Chinese incumbents.

All about politics: The impetus for the two sides bridging the divide was domestic politics, argued Ignacio García Bercero, a senior fellow at the Bruegel think tank in Brussels. “This is not Germany and France bringing forward a proposal that is going to help to find a broad compromise within the European Union,” he told Jordyn.

Who wants what: German Chancellor Friedrich Merz is under pressure after the far-right Alternative for Germany seized on the automotive crisis to help it win landslide victories in recent state elections. French President Emmanuel Macron, meanwhile, is eager to get both files through the legislative process this year before the country’s presidential election next spring.

Neither succeeded: Merz campaigned on overturning the combustion engine ban, but the Franco-German deal doesn’t go that far, instead introducing additional flexibilities for automakers. That hasn’t stopped the European People’s Party — part of the same political family as Merz — from claiming victory for its compromise deal in Parliament. It remains to be seen if the regulations will be finalized by end of year, with the plenary vote on CO2 standards delayed until December or until negotiations conclude on the IAA.

Read the whole saga here from Jordyn and Giorgio Leali.

Up next: The other 25 member countries will have their first opportunity to react to the deal at today’s Council working party meeting and another working party later this week focused on the CO2 standards. French and German diplomats are expected to attend and answer questions about the deal’s specifics.

PIT STOPS

Five members of TRAN will be in Montenegro and Albania from today to Wednesday to assess the countries’ progress in the EU accession process and the challenges they are facing in the transport sector.

Headlines

Here’s a recap of yesterday’s news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Europe vs. Elon: 5 ways the EU is trying to squeeze out Musk’s Starlink
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